

STAGE NINE · ENGLISH VOCABULARY FIRST SET

FIRSTS

English Vocabulary First Set

SESSION 1

Core Vocabulary Building Blocks

FIRSTS M1-M10

20 Professional Adjectives

- Study 5 at a time, not all 20 at once
- One real sentence beats a memorized definition
- Replaces “hardworking” on repeat

20 Action Verbs for Resumes

- Strong verb beats “was responsible for”
- Must be accurate, not just impressive
- Feeds directly into Stage Two's resume work

10 Transition Words

- Signal the logical relationship, not just “and”
- Wrong transition actively confuses a reader
- Classify before you use: cause? contrast? addition?

10 Academic Phrases

- Signposts where a reader is in your argument
- Overuse sounds stiff, not smart
- The paragraph must follow through on the structure

20 Workplace Phrases

- Everyday connective tissue of work email
- Rigid overuse sounds like a template
- Notice which you already use unconsciously

10 Presentation Words

- Replaces vague filler with precise structure
- Filler is often invisible to the speaker
- Feeds directly into Section 4 later this stage

10 Networking Words

- Genuine value, not transactional small talk
- Practice out loud — delivery matters as much as words
- Feeds directly into Section 5

10 Polite Expressions

- One repertoire beats one overused phrase
- Calibrate to context — not maximum formality always
- Stacking politeness reads as insincere

10 Academic/Business Idioms

- Comprehension alone is a valid, sufficient goal
- Use judiciously in cross-cultural settings
- Literal words rarely explain the real meaning

Vocabulary Reflection Exercise

- 5 genuinely personal sentences, not textbook ones
- Converts passive recognition into real fluency
- Tests retention across all of Section 1

SESSION 2

Written & Documentation Vocabulary

FIRSTS M11-M15

Professional Email Vocabulary

- Clarity and politeness can trade off — balance both
- Don't bury the actual point
- Practice on a real, recent email

Report & Memo Vocabulary

- Standard scaffolding of formal business writing
- The label must match the content underneath
- Feeds Stage Fourteen and Fifteen's report work

Agenda/Minutes Vocabulary

- Decision vs. action item vs. open discussion
- “We talked about” is genuinely too vague
- Every action item needs a named owner

Documenting Decisions & Next Steps

- Is it final, or still tentative? Be unambiguous
- A small wording gap causes real team friction
- High-leverage vocabulary — take it seriously

Summarizing Findings

- Match certainty language to actual evidence strength
- “Proves” vs. “suggests” vs. “indicates”
- Overstating undermines credibility once checked

SESSION 3

Meeting & Verbal Communication Vocabulary

FIRSTS M16-M25, M38

Meeting/Call Vocabulary

- Enter and exit a live conversation naturally
- Don't wait for perfect silence
- Practice out loud — this doesn't transfer from reading

Negotiation & Persuasion Vocabulary

- Advocate without sounding weak or adversarial
- Persuasion vs. manipulation is about intent
- Feeds Stage Fifteen's negotiation work

Follow-Up Vocabulary

- A reasonable ask doesn't need extensive apology
- Follow-up is where relationships quietly stall
- Brief and direct beats over-justified

Feedback Vocabulary

- Word choice carries as much weight as tone
- Over-softening can bury the actual point
- Precision, not bluntness, achieves real clarity

Follow-Up After Networking

- One real detail beats a generic template
- Timing matters as much as wording
- Extends M22 into a networking-specific context

Question-Asking Vocabulary

- Open-ended in structure, not just easily one-word-answered
- Rich conversation needs genuinely open questions
- Feeds Stage Two and Stage Three's interview work

Listening & Responding Vocabulary

- Makes active listening visible to the other person
- Words alone don't work without an accurate paraphrase
- Feeds Stage Two's Professional Listening Skill

Advanced Constructive Feedback

- For higher-stakes, more sensitive conversations
- Basic phrasing doesn't carry enough weight here
- Closes the section at real difficulty

SESSION 4

Presentation & Persuasion Vocabulary

FIRSTS M26-M31

Presentation Introduction Vocabulary

- Confident opening sets the tone for everything after
- Nerves are highest exactly when improvising is riskiest
- Feeds Stage Two's Introduction and Pitch

Structuring Presentations

- Verbal signposting, not just slide transitions
- Especially vital for longer, complex talks
- Match verbal structure to visual structure

Emphasizing Key Points

- Emphasizing everything emphasizes nothing
- Choose one or two points, genuinely
- Pause to let emphasis actually land

Audience Engagement Vocabulary

- The pause matters as much as the question
- Genuine incorporation, not performative asking
- Turns one-way delivery into real exchange

Q&A Handling Vocabulary

- Never bluff an answer you don't have
- Graceful acknowledgment plus a real follow-up
- Composure under genuine surprise is the real test

Persuasive Speaking Vocabulary

- A strong case still needs an explicit ask
- Comprehension is not the same as action
- Closes the section — mirrors Stage Two's Pitch

SESSION 5

Self-Presentation & Networking Vocabulary

FIRSTS M19-M21, M32

Professional Greeting Vocabulary

- Sets the tone for the whole interaction
- Calibrate to context and relationship stage
- No single universal default

Self-Introduction Vocabulary

- Strip out “I guess,” “sort of,” “maybe”
- Hedging undercuts even strong content
- Confident, not arrogant

Small Talk Vocabulary

- The entry point to deeper conversation
- Don't rush through it as a chore
- Genuine, low-pressure rapport-building

Workplace Expression Vocabulary

- Routine communication, not over- or under-formal
- Closes the section
- Stakes should match the register you choose

SESSION 6

Problem-Solving & Growth Vocabulary

FIRSTS M33-M37

Articulating Challenges

- Vague complaints give a team nothing to act on
- Specificity is the test: can someone actually help?
- The necessary first step toward solving anything

Proposing Solutions & Alternatives

- One option can feel closed to real input
- Genuine alternatives move a conversation forward
- Extends M33 into real forward motion

Analyzing Pros and Cons

- Name a real con for your own preferred option
- Avoids defaulting to whatever was said first
- Feeds Stage Fifteen's Cost-Benefit Analysis

Brainstorming & Ideation Vocabulary

- Idea-building language, not idea-evaluating
- “That won't work because” shuts down flow
- Feeds Stage Eight and Thirteen's brainstorming work

Reflecting on Personal Growth

- Pair growth language with a specific example
- The example carries the claim's weight
- Closes the entire stage

Stage Nine, Complete

One word or phrase you know you'll actually keep using.